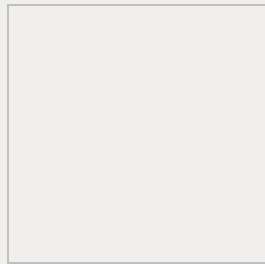


ON TECHNIQUE

The Baroque violin

The violins used in Vivaldi's time are superficially similar to today's models, but there are significant differences in their design. There is no chin rest on the Baroque violin, because early instrumentalists played it in a lower position than the one familiar today, and the fingerboard is shorter. Strings are made of organic materials (sheep intestines) rather than the metal or synthetic materials that superseded them. The sound produced is typically lighter and more intimate than that of the modern violin. Specialist performers of early music often use Baroque violins, either original instruments or replicas.



BAROQUE
VIOLIN, 1750